

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 5, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 36:1–15

1 "And you, son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel, and say, 'O mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord!

2 Thus says the Lord God: "Because the enemy has said of you, 'Aha! The ancient heights have become our possession,'"

3 therefore prophesy, and say, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Because they made you desolate and swallowed you up on every side, so that you became the possession of the rest of the nations, and you are taken up by the lips of talkers and slandered by the people"—

4 therefore, O mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord God! Thus says the Lord God to the mountains, the hills, the rivers, the valleys, the desolate wastes, and the cities that have been forsaken, which became plunder and mockery to the rest of the nations all around—

5 therefore thus says the Lord God: "Surely I have spoken in My burning jealousy against the rest of the nations and against all Edom, who gave My land to themselves as a possession, with wholehearted joy and spiteful minds, in order to plunder its open country."

6 "Therefore prophesy concerning the land of Israel, and say to the mountains, the hills, the rivers, and the valleys, 'Thus says the Lord God: "Behold, I have spoken in My jealousy and My fury, because you have borne the shame of the nations."

7 Therefore thus says the Lord God: "I have raised My hand in an oath that surely the nations that are around you shall bear their own shame.

8 But you, O mountains of Israel, you shall shoot forth your branches and yield your fruit to My people Israel, for they are about to come.

9 For indeed I am for you, and I will turn to you, and you shall be tilled and sown.

10 I will multiply men upon you, all the house of Israel, all of it; and the cities shall be inhabited and the ruins rebuilt.

11 I will multiply upon you man and beast; and they shall increase and bear young; I will make you inhabited as in former times, and do better for you than at your beginnings. Then you shall know that I am the Lord.

12 Yes, I will cause men to walk on you, My people Israel; they shall take possession of you, and you shall be their inheritance; no more shall you bereave them of children."

13 'Thus says the Lord God: "Because they say to you, 'You devour men and bereave your nation of children,'

14 therefore you shall devour men no more, nor bereave your nation anymore," says the Lord God.

15 "Nor will I let you hear the taunts of the nations anymore, nor bear the reproach of the peoples anymore, nor shall you cause your nation to stumble anymore," says the Lord God."

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to speak to "the mountains of Israel." The enemy, seeing the land in ruins, said, "Aha! The ancient heights have become our possession," and spread bad reports about the land everywhere (vv. 1–3).
 - God says He has spoken "in My burning jealousy" against the nations and against Edom, who grabbed His land for themselves, and He swears an oath that those nations will bear their own shame (vv. 5–7).
 - God gives this ruined land a string of promises: it will shoot forth branches and yield fruit, people and animals will multiply, cities will be inhabited and ruins rebuilt. He will do better for it than at its beginnings, and it will no longer hear the taunts of the nations (vv. 8–15).
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III. Passage Analysis

From "I am against you" to "I am for you"

"I am for you" reads literally "I am toward you," the same wording as Ezekiel 35:3, "I am against you," but with the opposite meaning; here it means God has Israel's good in view. "I will turn to you" reads literally "My face is toward you," meaning God looks

after Israel and treats it with favor. [1]

Same word, one flip in direction, and the whole situation changes. God's face had been turned away; now He turns and faces this piece of land nobody wanted.

Restoration isn't going back to normal—it's better than the beginning

"Do better for you than at your beginnings"—as in the case of Job. Whereas the heathen nations fall irrevocably, Israel shall be more than restored; its last estate shall exceed even its first. [2]

God's restoration isn't gluing the broken pieces back together and calling it good enough. "Better than at your beginnings" means the outcome ends up better than it was before anything broke.

IV. Reflection Question

If God said to you right now, "I am for you," what is the one thing you would want to hand over to Him?

Ezekiel 36 says God doesn't only rebuild the ruins—He promises to do better than at the beginning.

References

[1] Chinese Christian Bible Study Site (.org), Chuan Zhu Bible Commentary (Ezek. 36:9), <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/26Ezek/26GT36.htm>

[2] BibleHub.com, Jamieson-Fausset-Brown Commentary (Ezek. 36:11), <https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/36-11.htm>